

DeepThinkTrader Setup Guide

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CRITICAL WARNING: Start with paper trading ONLY. Never use real money until you have backtested for 3+ months. Trading bots can lose 100% of capital. This project is educational and experimental.

1. Required API Keys

You need three free API accounts. All keys go in the `.env` file (never commit this file).

1.1 Alpaca Markets (Paper Trading)

1. Go to **alpaca.markets** and create a free account
2. Navigate to **Paper Trading** dashboard
3. Click **API Keys** → **Generate New Key**
4. Copy both the **API Key ID** and **Secret Key** (secret shown only once!)

Variable	Description	Example
ALPACA_API_KEY	Your Alpaca API Key ID	PK... (20 chars)
ALPACA_SECRET_KEY	Your Alpaca Secret Key	abc123... (40 chars)
ALPACA_BASE_URL	Paper trading endpoint	https://paper-api.alpaca.markets

1.2 NewsAPI

1. Go to **newsapi.org** and register for free
2. Copy your API key from the dashboard
3. Free tier: 500 requests/day (sufficient for hourly research on 5 tickers)

Variable	Description	Example
NEWSAPI_KEY	Your NewsAPI key	abc123def456... (32 chars)

1.3 Reddit API (PRAW)

1. Log into Reddit, go to **reddit.com/prefs/apps**
2. Click "**create another app...**" at the bottom
3. Select "**script**" type
4. Name: DeepThinkTrader
5. Redirect URI: `http://localhost:8080`
6. Click **Create app**
7. Note the **client ID** (under the app name) and **secret**

Variable	Description	Example
REDDIT_CLIENT_ID	App client ID (under app name)	aBcDeFgHiJkLmN (14 chars)
REDDIT_CLIENT_SECRET	App secret	xYzAbCdEfGhIjKlMnOpQrStUvWx (27 chars)
REDDIT_USER_AGENT	Identifies your app to Reddit	DeepThinkTrader/1.0

2. Trading Parameters

All configurable via `.env` file. Defaults are conservative for paper trading.

Parameter	Variable	Default	Description
Account Size	ACCOUNT_SIZE	\$50,000	Starting paper balance
Watchlist	WATCHLIST	NVDA,TSLA,AAPL,AMD,SPY	Comma separated tickers
Max Risk/Trade	MAX_RISK_PER_TRADE	0.02 (2%)	Max % account risked per position
Max Daily Loss	MAX_DAILY_LOSS	0.05 (5%)	Hard stop — no more trades today
Min Conviction	MIN_CONVICTION	8	Score threshold to execute (1-10)
Research Interval	RESEARCH_INTERVAL_MINUTES	60	Minutes between research cycles
Min R:R Ratio	MIN_REWARD_RISK_RATIO	2.0	

			Take-pr must be stop-los
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3. Risk Management Rules (Hardcoded)

These safety checks run BEFORE every trade and cannot be overridden via configuration.

Rule	Description	Action if Triggered
Conviction Gate	Analysis conviction must be $\geq$ MIN_CONVICTION	HOLD — no trade
Position Risk Cap	Max loss per position $\leq$ MAX_RISK_PER_TRADE	BLOCKED
R:R Minimum	Take-profit $\geq$ MIN_REWARD_RISK_RATIO $\times$ stop-loss	BLOCKED
Daily Loss Limit	Realized P&L today must be within MAX_DAILY_LOSS	BLOCKED for rest of day
Max Open Positions	No more than 5 simultaneous positions	BLOCKED
No Duplicates	Cannot open second position in same ticker	BLOCKED
Market Hours	Must be within US market hours (9:30-4:00 ET)	BLOCKED
Revenge Trading	3+ consecutive losses triggers cooldown	BLOCKED + warning

4. Quick Setup Checklist

#	Step	Done?
1	Create Alpaca paper account and get API keys	☐
2	Get NewsAPI key (free tier)	☐
3	Create Reddit app and get PRAW credentials	☐
4	Copy <code>.env.template</code> to <code>.env</code> and fill in keys	☐
5	Create Python venv and install requirements	☐
6	Run <code>python main.py once</code> to test single cycle	☐
7	Run <code>streamlit run dashboard.py</code> to verify dashboard	☐
8	Start scheduled loop: <code>python main.py</code>	☐

5. .env File Template

```
# Alpaca API (Paper Trading)
ALPACA_API_KEY=your_alpaca_api_key
ALPACA_SECRET_KEY=your_alpaca_secret_key
ALPACA_BASE_URL=https://paper-api.alpaca.markets

# NewsAPI
NEWSAPI_KEY=your_newsapi_key

# Reddit (PRAW)
REDDIT_CLIENT_ID=your_reddit_client_id
REDDIT_CLIENT_SECRET=your_reddit_client_secret
REDDIT_USER_AGENT=DeepThinkTrader/1.0
```

```
# Trading Parameters
ACCOUNT_SIZE=50000
WATCHLIST=NVDA,TSLA,AAPL,AMD,SPY
MAX_RISK_PER_TRADE=0.02
MAX_DAILY_LOSS=0.05
MIN_CONVICTION=8
RESEARCH_INTERVAL_MINUTES=60
MIN_REWARD_RISK_RATIO=2.0
```

DeepThinkTrader v1.0 — Paper Trading Mode Only

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